

Same plug. Different jobs.

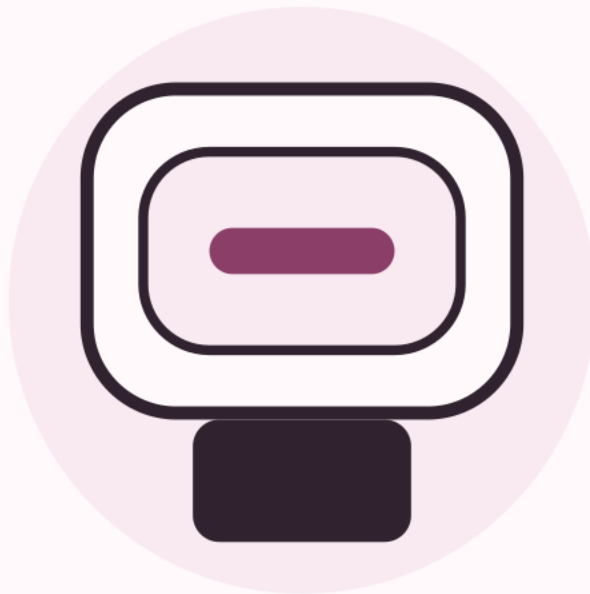
Why can one USB-C cable charge a laptop,
but another cannot connect its screen?



Same shape. Different limits.

USB-C describes the connector.

The shape tells you it fits.
It does not tell you everything it can do.



A connector shape, not a full specification.

One cable. Three separate questions.



POWER

How much can it charge?



DATA

How fast can files move?



VIDEO

Can it connect a screen?

Fast charging does not mean fast files.

A cable can support high charging power and still transfer files at USB 2.0 speeds.

ONE POSSIBLE CABLE

240W

Power rating



USB 2.0

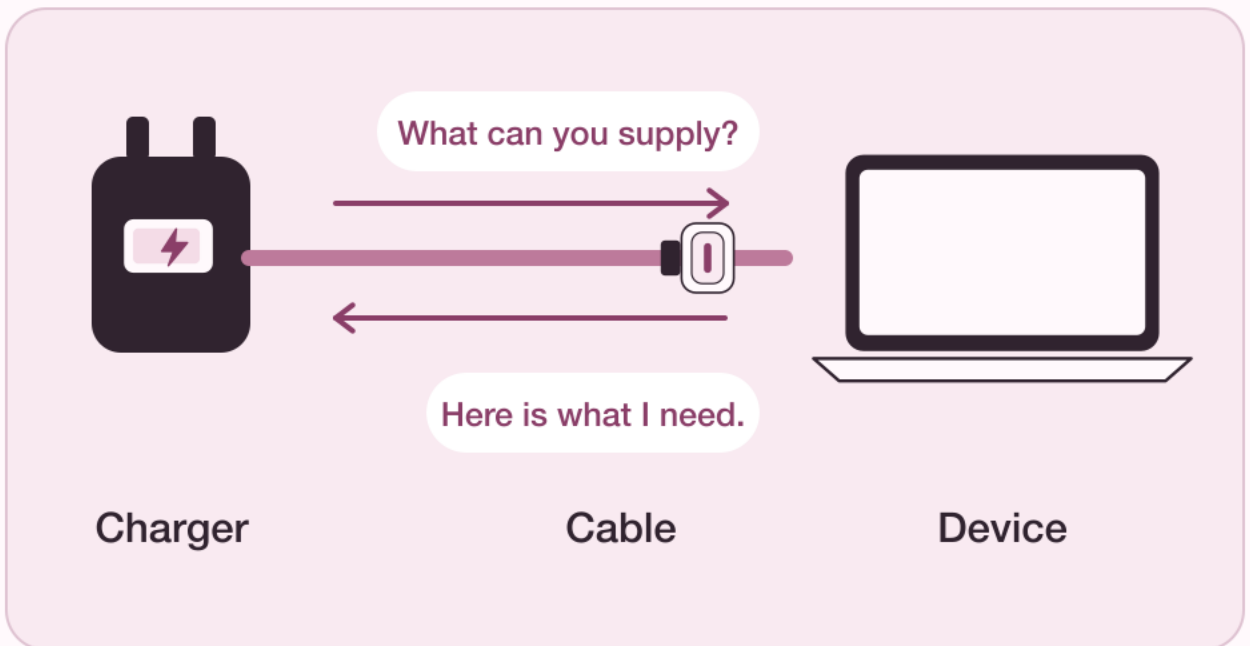
Data capability



High power and faster data are separate specs.
The bars illustrate capability, not measured speed.

The charger does not force in all its power.

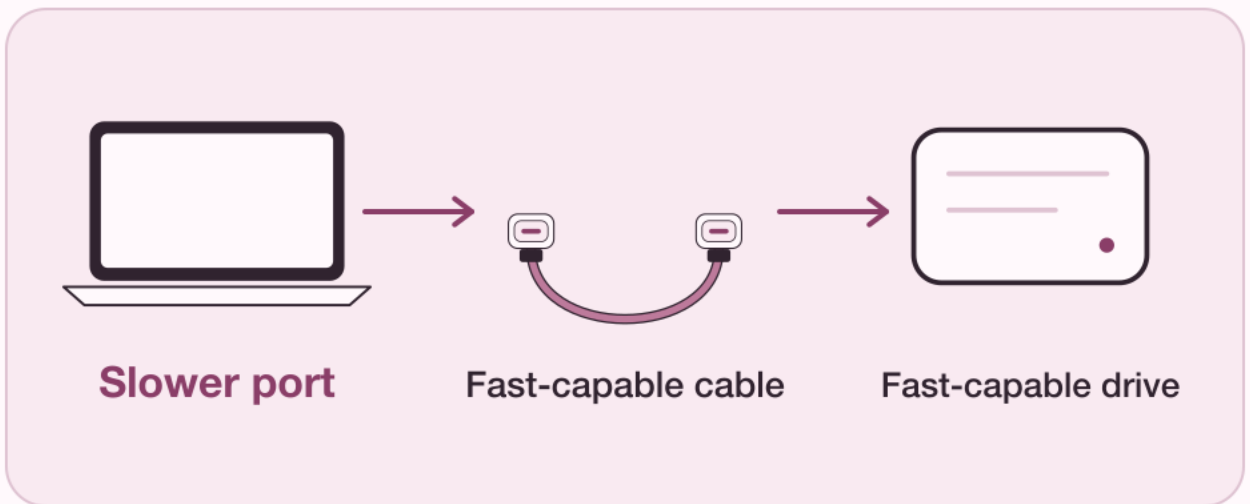
With USB Power Delivery, the charger and device agree a supported power level.
The cable must support it too.



A 240W cable does not make a phone take 240W.
Its rating is a limit it supports.

A fast cable cannot fix a slower connection.

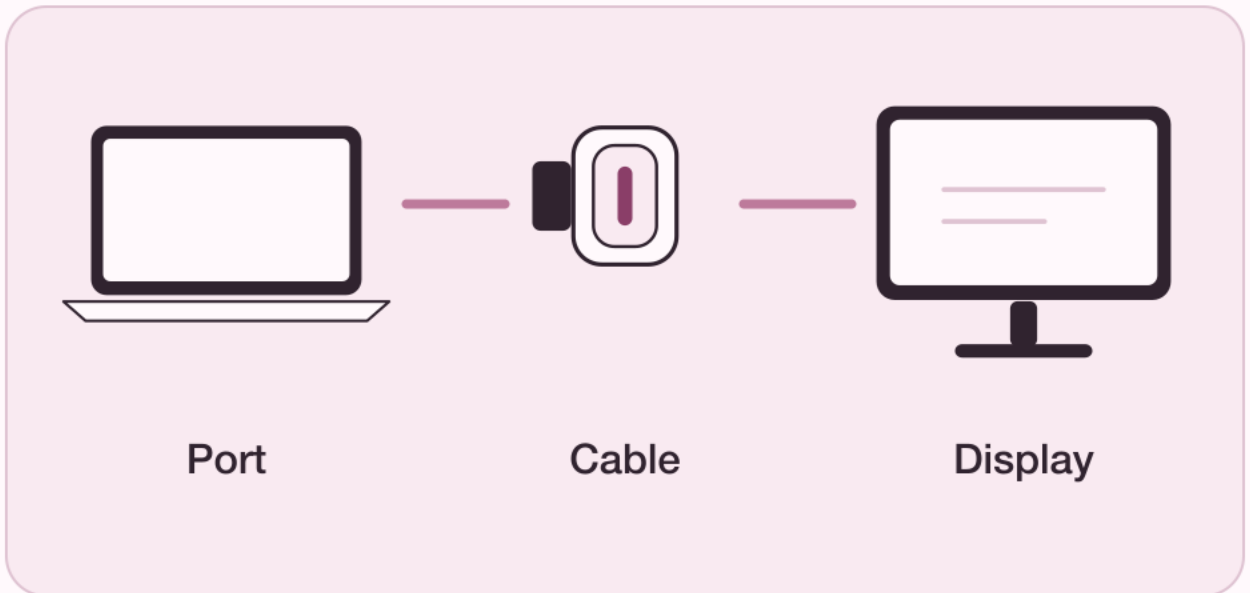
The computer, cable and connected device all matter. A slower link limits the connection.



The connection is still limited by the slower port.
Supported link speed is not a promise
of real-world copy speed.

Charging works. Screen stays blank?

Video support must be there too:
in the computer's port, cable and display.



Check each part for the video connection you need.
A working power connection is not proof of video.

Read the specs. The shape is not enough.

FICTIONAL SPECIFICATION LABEL

Power

Watts / W

Data speed

Mbps or Gbps

Video

Explicit display support

Check the product specs, not just how the cable looks.

Buy for the job. Not just the plug.

- ✓ Laptop charging → Power
- ✓ Large file transfers → Data speed
- ✓ External screen → Video support

The best cable is the one that supports your job.
Keep this checklist for the next one you buy.